

Soyoung Lee

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Education

- **University of Michigan**, Ann Arbor, MI
Ph.D. Candidate in Information (2022 – *Present*) / Advisor: Nicole Ellison
M.S. Information (2020-2022) / Advisor: Kentaro Toyama
- **Chung-Ang University**, Seoul, Korea
B.A. English Language and Literature, *Magna Cum Laude* (2014)

Research Experience

- **Understanding Human-AI Relationships** (*Principal Investigator*, 2025 – *Present*)
 - An exploratory interview study on deeply connected relationships with AI social chatbots around the concept of mutuality building and relationship boundaries
- **The “Community Tech Workers”: A community-driven model to support economic mobility by bridging the digital divide** / PIs: Tawanna Dillahunt, Julie Hui, Mustafa Naseem, Kentaro Toyama (*Research Assistant*, 2021 – 2024)
 - Designed, implemented and analyzed data about basic digital skills learning using survey, semi-structured interview, participant observation methods
 - Assisted development of a measure of community digital capacity
 - Facilitated digital skills training with a partnership with a non-profit organization following community-based participatory design approach

Publication

- Hui, J., Filipof, E. M., **Lee, S.**, Corvite, S., Dillahunt, T.R. (2026). ‘I Know I Can Do the Job, It’s Just Putting It Down’: Using Personas as a Mirror to Identify Strengths. *Proceedings of the 2026 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems* (pp. 1-44)
- **Lee, S.**, Hui, J., Dillahunt, T. R. (2025). Sociocultural Factors in Digital Skills Learning In a Community-Based Learning Intervention among U.S. Public Housing Adults. *Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction*, 9(2), CSCW172, 1-26.
- Dillahunt, R. T., Shedden, K., Filipof, E. M., **Lee, S.**, Naseem M., Toyama, K., Hui, J. (2025). The Development of a New Measure of Collective Digital Literacy: Community Digital Capacity. *Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction*, 9(2), 1-33.
- **Lee, S.**, & Toyama, K (2024). Friendship Formation in an Enforced Online Regime: Findings from a U.S. University Under COVID. *Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction*, Vol.8, No. CSCW1, Article 168.

(Lightly Peer Reviewed/Poster)

- Dillahunt, T. R., K Shedden, Filipof, E. M., **Lee, S.**, Naseem M., Toyama, K., Hui, J. (2024). Toward a Measure of Collective Digital Capacity: An Exploratory

Analysis. *Extended Abstracts of the 2024 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*.

- **Lee, S.**, Hui, J., Rowe, Z., Dillahunt, T. (2023). "A Collective Approach to Providing Digital Skills Training Among U.S. Public Housing Residents" *Extended Abstracts of the 2023 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*.

- Invited Talks**
- Conference presentation in Comm Horizons @ UCD 2026: Communication in the Age of AI and Algorithms (May 2026, *scheduled*)
 - Class guest speaker for SI 316 Interpersonal and Psychological Implications of Social Media, University of Michigan (March 2026)
 - Paper Talk "Sociocultural Factors in Digital Skills Learning In a Community-Based Learning Intervention among U.S. Public Housing Adults" ACM Conference on Computer Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing (October 2025)
 - Paper Talk "The Development of a New Measure of Collective Digital Literacy: Community Digital Capacity" ACM Conference on Computer Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing (October 2025)
 - Paper Talk "Friendship Formation in an Enforced Online Regime: Findings from a U.S. University Under COVID" ACM Conference on Computer Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing (October 2024)

- Teaching Experience**
- Graduate Student Instructor*
- SI 303 Introduction to Qualitative Research (Fall 24, 25)
 - SI 622 Needs Assessment and Usability Evaluation (Winter 25, 26)
 - Led class lecture on *Survey Methods for UX Research*

- Grant /Scholarship**
- Precandidate Rackham Graduate Student Research Grant \$1,500 (2025)
 - Rackham Conference Travel Grant & School of Information Doctoral Student Travel Grant (2023, 2024, 2025)
 - Ascend Education as Equalizer Scholarship \$5,000 (2022)

- Paper Review**
- ACM CSCW (2024, 2025, 2026)
 - ACM CHI (2026)
 - AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence (AAAI-26) (2026)

- Student Mentoring**
- Mila Filipof (BS, MS in Information Science)
 - Pioline Choudhury (BSE in Computer Science)

- Service**
- Rackham Student AI Working Groups (2026)
 - UMSI Graduate Student Instructor orientation panelist (2025)
 - UMSI Master's Thesis Option Program experience panelist (2024)

**Industry
Experience**

The Cigna Group, Seoul, Korea

Assistant Product Manager, Digital Platform Team (2017 – 2020)

- Led new digital product and UX strategy development
- Conducted qualitative (user shadowing, interviews) and quantitative (A/B testing, web log, heatmap) digital product data analysis

Communication Specialist, IT Project Management Office (2014 – 2017)

- Designed and conducted change readiness assessment surveys for 800+ employees and 20+ focus group interviews with business/IT teams for new IT operation system
- Developed and coordinated new IT system-training for 7,000+ users; authored system manual documents as user guides